Himaayah Schools
TEENAGERS BUILDING CIRCLE

GUIDE

إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ

"Actions are judged by intentions." (al-Bukhārī 1, Muslim 1907)

Month 1

Starting Strong

Intention, identity and a strong start. A guide for students for each live session this month.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Month 1: Starting Strong

Every journey begins with a reason. This month you decide why you are here, learn how learning really works, and set up the habits and tools you will use all year.

> إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ
>
> **“Actions are judged by intentions.”**
>
> al-Bukhārī 1, Muslim 1907

How to use this guide

1. **Before each session**, read that session’s short teaching below. It takes two minutes.
2. **During the session**, take notes on the lines provided and write one question to ask.
3. **After the session**, do the “Try it” action within two days.
4. **Every day**, tick your habit tracker. **Every Sunday**, spend five minutes reviewing the week.
5. **At the end of the month**, complete the Month Review and show it to a parent or your facilitator.

This month at a glance

Week	Deen	Educational Development	Skills	Personal Development
Week 1 Why am I here?	Renew your intention	How learning really works	Your learning toolkit	Know yourself
Week 2 The anchor of the day	Prayer on time	A place to study	Notes you can use	Set a SMART goal
Week 3 Habits that stick	Small and steady	Reading with purpose	Asking good questions	The habit loop
Week 4 Review and reset	Muḥāsabah: taking stock	A revision plan	Organising your week	Celebrate progress

The month's challenge

Seven days in a row: pray every prayer on time, keep your one small daily act, and write your nightly muḥāsabah.

Week 1 Why am I here?

Deen: Renew your intention

Before any action, the heart decides why. The same hour of study can be for Allah or for show. Make the intention first, then act, and renew it when you feel tired.

Try it this week

Write one sentence: “I am joining the Circle to …”. Read it before each session this week.

My notes and questions

Educational Development: How learning really works

Rereading feels like learning but is weak. You remember what you retrieve: closing the page and testing yourself. Spacing your study over days beats one long night.

Try it this week

After a lesson, close your notes and write what you remember for three minutes. Then check.

My notes and questions

Skills: Your learning toolkit

A tidy folder and a notebook save hours. Name files with the date and topic so you can find them later, and keep one place for everything from the Circle.

Try it this week

Create a folder called “Circle” with a sub-folder for each month. Save this guide there.

My notes and questions

Personal Development: Know yourself

Growth starts with honesty. Strengths show where to build; weak areas show where to practise. Your values decide which goals are worth chasing.

Try it this week

List three strengths and two areas to grow. Ask a parent or friend to add one strength you missed.

My notes and questions

Week 2 The anchor of the day

Deen: Prayer on time

The five prayers are the frame of a Muslim's day. The Prophet ﷺ said the first thing a servant is asked about on the Day of Resurrection is the prayer (at-Tirmidhī, 413). Everything else is built around it.

Try it this week

Set an alarm for each prayer. Tick them off on the tracker at the back.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Educational Development: A place to study

Your environment shapes your focus. A clear desk, good light and the phone out of reach beat willpower every time.

Try it this week

Set up one study spot. Remove everything you do not need and put your phone in another room for 30 minutes.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Week 2: The anchor of the day (continued)

Skills: Notes you can use

Good notes are short and organised: a heading, key points, and a question or two in the margin. Copying everything is not note-taking.

Try it this week

In your next session, divide the page in two: notes on the left, questions and key words on the right.

My notes and questions

Personal Development: Set a SMART goal

A goal is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound. “Do better” is a wish; “read 10 pages a day for 30 days” is a goal.

Try it this week

Write one SMART goal for this month and share it with your facilitator.

My notes and questions

Week 3 Habits that stick

Deen: Small and steady

The Prophet ﷺ said the deeds most loved by Allah are the most regular, even if small (al-Bukhārī 6464, Muslim 783). A page a day beats a juz once a month.

Try it this week

Pick one small daily act, such as a page of Qur'an or the morning adhkar, and keep it for seven days.

My notes and questions

Educational Development: Reading with purpose

Before reading, skim the headings and ask what you want to find out. Read in sections, then pause to say the main idea aloud.

Try it this week

Take one page from any subject. Skim, ask two questions, read, then summarise in two sentences.

My notes and questions

Week 3: Habits that stick (continued)

Skills: Asking good questions

A good question is specific and shows what you have already tried. It saves time and earns respect from teachers.

Try it this week

Write three questions before the next session. Ask at least one.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Personal Development: The habit loop

Every habit has a cue, a routine and a reward. The easiest way to start a habit is to attach it to one you already keep, such as a prayer.

Try it this week

Attach a five-minute review to the end of one prayer each day this week.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Week 4 Review and reset

Deen: Muḥāsabah: taking stock

It is reported from ʿUmar that he said to hold yourselves to account before you are held to account. A few quiet minutes each night keep the heart honest.

Try it this week

Each night, write one thing that went well and one thing to fix tomorrow.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Educational Development: A revision plan

Revision works when it is planned. Put small, regular slots in your week and rotate your subjects.

Try it this week

Draw a one-week timetable with five 25-minute study slots and mark which subject goes where.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Week 4: Review and reset (continued)

Skills: Organising your week

A calendar turns intentions into appointments. Write down sessions, study slots and deadlines in one place you check every day.

Try it this week

Put next week's four sessions and your study slots in a calendar or planner.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Personal Development: Celebrate progress

Gratitude keeps you going. Noticing small wins builds the confidence to do harder things, and thanking people strengthens relationships.

Try it this week

Write three wins from this month and thank one person who helped you.

My notes and questions

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Daily habit tracker

Tick each box when you have done it. Be honest: the tracker is for you.

Week 1

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur’an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month’s “Try it”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 2

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur’an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month’s “Try it”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 3

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur’an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month’s “Try it”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 4

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur’an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month’s “Try it”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Month review

Rate yourself honestly from 1 (needs support) to 5 (excelling), then write one win and one thing to improve.

Pillar	Rating (circle one)	One thing I did well	One thing to improve
Deen	1 2 3 4 5		
Educational Development	1 2 3 4 5		
Skills	1 2 3 4 5		
Personal Development	1 2 3 4 5		

My biggest win this month

.....

.....

What was hardest, and why

.....

.....

What I will do next month

.....

.....

Facilitator's comment

.....

Parent's comment

.....

A page for parents

This month, ask one question each evening: “What did you learn today?” Listen without correcting. Make sure there is a calm place and a regular time for study, and keep phones out of the room during sessions.

- **What the monthly report shows.** Your teenager’s facilitator sends a report each month with attendance, a rating for each of the four pillars, assignments handed in and a personal note.
- **Three questions to ask this month.** What did you learn that surprised you? Which session helped you most, and why? What is one thing I can do to support you?
- **How to help.** A calm place and time to study, early nights, and your interest. Praise effort and honesty more than marks.

> رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَاجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّاتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَاجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا
>
> **“Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and offspring comfort to our eyes and make us a leader for the righteous.”**
>
> Al-Furqān 25:74

Next month

Month 2: Discipline and Time. Plan your days, beat procrastination, protect your rest.

This guide is for the personal and family use of the student who bought it. Please do not copy or resell it. © Himaayah Schools, 2026.

Four sessions a week, one clear focus.

Every journey begins with a reason. This month you decide why you are here, learn how learning really works, and set up the habits and tools you will use all year.

- Week 1: Why am I here?
- Week 2: The anchor of the day
- Week 3: Habits that stick
- Week 4: Review and reset
- A habit tracker, a month review and a page for parents

Join the Teenagers Building Circle

Deen, education, skills and personal development, live four times a week for ages 13 to 19.

himaayahschools.com/teenagers-building-circle